

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 4 OF SIX

Nigga, the Peace Table Has to Stand Up

Puzzles, mechanisms, creative toys and retro desktop diversions

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan's creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden's scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [The Camera Did Not Get to Name Everybody](#) - page 48. Drag, identity and the audience.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 4. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P121	P122	P123	P124	P125	P126	P127	P128
2. Ready for conversation	P129	P130	P131	P132	P133	P134	P135	P136
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P137	P138	P139	P140	P141	P142	P143	P144
4. Here for the atmosphere	P145	P146	P147	P148	P149	P150	P151	P152
5. Open to a wildcard	P153	P154	P155	P156	P157	P158	P159	P160

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Battle of the Unassembled Stage

The mechanism inside my enormous box was a curtain opener with no curtain, a revolving stand with no assigned purpose, and a gold lever so impressive it distracted me from both omissions.

Rae put the delivery sheet on the table. "Which thing does the useful thing?"

I pointed at the lever.

She lifted it. Nothing happened anywhere else.

Tank nodded. "Portable authority, nigga."

Our venue annex was settled. People knew where the rooms were, the quiet space had a working lamp, and Velvet's dressing area no longer doubled as a shortcut for my sense of symmetry. All that remained was to build a ceremony capable of holding the people, the paper, the costumes, and my deteriorating confidence without collapsing under any of them.

I had prepared for this task by ordering objects.

Mika had prepared by measuring. This gave them an unfair advantage the moment we began. They placed their tiny hotel model on a clear patch of table, laid out the agreed route, and asked us to stop adding towers until the actual furniture worked.

Kit, the white butch librarian, carried the lighting plan under one arm and searched for her glasses with the other hand. They were in her jacket pocket. Remy discovered them while looking for the microphone clip, received a grateful smile, and ruined it with a pun about seeing eye to eye. Kit laughed anyway, which encouraged him beyond the interests of the room.

Velvet arrived wearing half her performance costume and carrying the other half in a bag large enough to contain a small successful business. She wanted a clear turn beside the stage, a usable mirror, and the fee we had already agreed. Her budget instincts were sharper than my scissors, and considerably more likely to cut something.

Rae wanted the signing table to stand still. This had become her recurring demand because I had repeatedly purchased things that photographed better than they supported elbows. Nia wanted that table near the room, where people could speak without being exhibited like auction lots. She also wanted to ask Rae about the dance, but every time she approached, somebody handed her another page written in my decorative language.

Auntie June and Dez took their chairs near the rehearsal area. June wore the posture of a retired bus driver who could still tell when somebody had parked badly from across a room. Dez wore June's old jacket, repaired so carefully that its disputed ownership had survived longer than many actual institutions.

Between them lay the Blue Comet rental invoice. The peace terms were on its back. June had signed the front and Dez the back, an arrangement that had supported fifty-nine years of each declaring the other's signature absent. I had initially treated this as a tragedy of diplomacy. Shawna said it sounded like two women who enjoyed having an excuse to bring up the same night.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The first Great Butch versus Stud War belonged to our invented 1967 social club history, complete with contradictory jukebox accounts and an unreasonable quantity of emotional investment in one borrowed jacket. The second had reached the stage-equipment phase. Nobody's dignity required a vote. My purchases, unfortunately, required several.

I proposed raising the signing table on a platform beneath the illuminated portrait. Rae sat at the table and asked me to hand her the pen. I had to walk around a vase, a costume rack, and the unconnected lever to reach her.

"Nigga," she said, "we have discovered the problem."

Mika moved the vase. Kit moved the rack. I held the lever because nobody had yet found it a job. Shawna put a small ordinary pen in my other hand and guided me back along the clear route.

"Try this version."

I handed the pen to Rae. She wrote a test word, pushed gently against the table, and looked up. It wobbled.

Tank took the lever from me. For one terrible second I thought he had discovered its purpose. Then he set it aside and helped Rae inspect the legs.

The war had finally found its first objective: a table that could survive somebody agreeing with somebody else.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P121 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Baba Is You

Edition considered: PC release

Discover puzzles where moving the words changes the rules, if a small action leading to a big conceptual surprise appeals.

What you do. Move around compact boards, push rule words into new arrangements and observe how the changed rules affect the puzzle.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The simple movement system supports difficult reasoning; verify movement repeat, undo and exact controls before choosing it.

Why it might click. Baba Is You turns the rules of a puzzle into objects you can move. A short arrangement of words can transform what a wall, flag or character does. The appeal is the surprise of realizing that the rule you assumed was fixed is actually the thing to manipulate.

The full catch. The small number of movement actions should not be confused with easy reasoning. The developer describes a large collection of increasingly inventive rule interactions. Reading the words, predicting consequences and revising a plan can become demanding. Check the exact movement, undo and restart controls rather than assuming they are comfortable because the board is compact.

Try this first. Try an introductory level and deliberately move one rule word. Observe what changes before attempting a long solution or consulting an entire set of hints.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P121 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Baba Is You

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / HOST IS OPTIONAL Was an Act of War

Baba Is You had me thinking about moveable rules, which was unfortunate because Rae was already rearranging the magnetic words on my ceremony board.

I had written HOST IS ESSENTIAL. She changed it to HOST IS SEATED.

"Nigga, that's constitutional vandalism."

Kit changed STAGE IS GRAND to STAGE IS CLEAR. Velvet added PAID beside SHOW and folded her arms until I acknowledged the amendment.

Auntie June examined the board. She said the Blue Comet jukebox dispute had begun with people treating their own rules as sacred. Dez said it had begun with June playing the same song four times.

"Because it was good."

"Because you had all the quarters."

Remy moved the word SHARED beside MICROPHONE. The resulting sentence was ugly but useful. I put OPTIONAL beside my speech as a generous gesture, then tried to remove it when everyone applauded.

Shawna kept her hand over the magnet. Nigga, my wife had discovered a very small way to hold executive power.

Aiden's verdict. The ceremony board keeps shared equipment and an optional host speech. June and Dez dispute the historical jukebox allocation, while Shawna guards the magnet that makes the present tolerable.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/736260/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P122 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Patrick's Parabox

Edition considered: PC release

Explore boxes within boxes, if discovering how nested spaces fit together sounds more interesting than following a conventional character story.

What you do. Move pieces through recursive box arrangements, reconsider the spatial relationships and try new paths through the compact puzzle.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The developer declares untimed input, but nested relationships can create substantial reasoning and memory demands.

Why it might click. Patrick's Parabox explores boxes that contain other boxes, including recursive arrangements. The repeated act of pushing gains new meaning as the space folds into itself. Its interest is in discovering how a small set of relationships can support surprisingly rich puzzles.

The full catch. The current Steam listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Spatial nesting can still require holding several relationships in mind even when the controls are limited. Verify key repeat, undo and any zoom behavior in the actual version. There is little conventional character story to carry the experience if the recursive logic itself does not appeal.

Try this first. Play the earliest introduction to entering and leaving a box. Explain one relationship aloud if useful, then try a move that tests that explanation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P122 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Patrick's Parabox

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Table Was Inside the Table's Box

Patrick's Parabox put boxes inside boxes while the hotel delivered our signing furniture in a crate that seemed to contain another crate.

Mika opened the first. Tank opened the second. I announced that anticipation increased the ceremony's value.

Rae found a tiny model table inside the third.

"Nigga, you ordered the display sample."

I examined the invoice. The scale measurement had looked like a decorative fraction.

Velvet sat the miniature table on her palm and asked whether the coalition planned to sign with individual eyelashes. Remy produced a pencil nub and offered a suitably modest fanfare.

Mika was delighted. They added the model to their hotel collection, then borrowed a full-size table from the lounge. Rae checked its legs. Kit arranged the chairs around it.

The small table cost too much to throw away, so Shawna placed it beside my enormous receipt. In that arrangement, at least, the proportions accurately represented my evening.

Aiden's verdict. The borrowed table receives the actual chairs, while Mika keeps the expensive miniature. My receipt becomes a scale reference for the distance between anticipation and reading the purchase description.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1260520/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P123 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Stephen's Sausage Roll

Edition considered: PC release

Work through compact spatial puzzles built around a comic cooking premise, if figuring out a demanding arrangement sounds satisfying.

What you do. Inspect the puzzle space, move through its arrangement and test how your actions change the problem in front of you.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The primary description is brief; controls and full-game timing remain unresolved, and the reasoning can be demanding.

Why it might click. Stephen's Sausage Roll is a compact three-dimensional puzzle game built around unusually exact spatial problems. Its appeal is the satisfaction of understanding a small arrangement deeply enough to make it work. It belongs on the reasoning shelf for someone who enjoys a stubborn little mechanism more than an expansive story.

The full catch. The inspected primary storefront supplies very little detailed control information, so this card does not certify timing, holds or the full interaction set. The title's cheerful food premise should not imply easy puzzles. Treat both input comfort and the amount of planning as questions for an early trial, with no expectation of quick completion.

Try this first. Inspect the first small puzzle and test a single movement. If the rules interest you, try one hypothesis; if they merely irritate, leave the plate unfinished.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P123 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Stephen's Sausage Roll

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Sausage Had a Seating Preference

Stephen's Sausage Roll made the food layout look like an exact spatial problem, which Rae took as permission to intervene in the catering arrangement.

The sausages were under a hot lamp. The bread was across the table. The plates sat behind a vase taller than Remy.

"Nigga, who designed this, a person who hates wrists?"

I admitted choosing the vase. It was shaped like a victory flame.

Dez rotated the platter and moved the bread beside it. June shifted the plates. They performed this small cooperation without acknowledging its diplomatic significance, so I immediately ruined it by announcing the historic moment.

June put a plate in my hand.

"Be historic over there."

Rae used the freed space for a clear serving route. Velvet approached, assembled dinner without touching the victory flame, and declared the arrangement fit for performers of international stature.

Tank asked whether international stature wanted her second sausage. She moved her plate.

Negotiations remained rigorous.

Aiden's verdict. The serving arrangement prioritizes reachable plates and actual food. June and Dez decline a commemorative announcement, while Velvet retains both sausages under a clear and vigorously defended claim.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-game Steam description is very brief ('A simple 3d puzzle game'); source supports identity and basic genre, not detailed control or difficulty certification. Scene is original fiction. Specific input and full-game timing remain to be checked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/353540/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P124 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Snakebird

Edition considered: PC original game

Guide an awkward growing creature through spatial puzzles, if planning around its shape sounds like an enjoyable challenge to explore.

What you do. Move the creature through a puzzle arrangement and account for how its changing shape affects the possible route.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The developer calls the puzzles challenging; colorful creatures and limited controls do not establish easy reasoning.

Why it might click. Snakebird makes the length and shape of its fruit-eating creatures central to spatial puzzles. What looks like a small comic animal becomes a tool for crossing, supporting and arranging a route. The attraction is the way a simple change in body length changes the whole problem.

The full catch. The developer explicitly calls the game deceptively challenging. A friendly drawing and a small board should not be sold as easy reasoning. Check directional input, switching between creatures and recovery from mistakes. The card does not establish universal no-timing behavior from genre alone; its strongest case is for a player who enjoys concentrated spatial experimentation.

Try this first. Try the earliest fruit-and-exit arrangement. Notice what the new length permits before attempting to plan several moves ahead.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P124 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Snakebird

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Feather Boa Outgrew the Floor Plan

Snakebird's changing shape suggested a problem Velvet had already brought into the room: every time she improved her costume, it occupied another chair.

Her feather boa crossed the model map like a glamorous river.

Mika lifted one end. Rae moved the snack bowl away from the other. Remy said the outfit now required its own entrance music and a turning permit.

"Nigga, it's called presence," Velvet said.

Kit measured the proposed stage passage with a ribbon. Velvet tried the turn, caught a feather on my portrait stand, and removed the portrait without consulting its subject.

The turn worked.

I argued that the obstruction had been artistically important. Velvet wrapped the boa around my shoulders and invited me to demonstrate a better route.

I became trapped between two chairs while everybody watched. Shawna freed one end, kissed my cheek, and asked whether presence wanted help.

Presence accepted. The stage passage became wider, and my portrait began another involuntary tour of the building.

Aiden's verdict. The costume gets a tested turning space and the portrait gets relocated. Presence may request assistance without surrendering glamour, a provision I endorse after briefly becoming part of the furniture.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/357300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P125 / A PLACE TO START

Snakebird Primer

Edition considered: PC separate prequel game

Try a gentler introduction to Snakebird's spatial idea, if a clearer opening challenge makes discovering its rules more appealing.

What you do. Work through the separate Primer game's introductory puzzles, moving the creature and learning how its shape affects each route.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. This is the easier separate game, not a guarantee of effortless puzzles; movement and undo still need checking.

Why it might click. Snakebird Primer is a separate set of puzzles designed as a more approachable introduction to Snakebird's spatial ideas. The developer explicitly contrasts its easier island with the original game's serious challenges. It can be a useful place to discover whether moving and shaping these creatures is pleasurable before choosing the harder title.

The full catch. Easier is a comparison, not a personal guarantee. Directional movement, visual planning and keeping track of a changing shape still matter. Check undo, restart and control repetition in the exact release. The appeal remains puzzle logic rather than rich character dialogue, and a player need not graduate to the original game to justify enjoying this one.

Try this first. Complete or explore one introductory arrangement, focusing on how fruit changes the creature. Let curiosity about the next idea decide whether to continue.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P125 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Snakebird Primer

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Introductory Boa Saved My Marriage

After the full feather arrangement defeated me, Kit proposed a smaller rehearsal costume. Snakebird Primer was on the screen, offering a gentler introduction to its own spatial ideas.

Velvet selected a short scarf and draped it around my shoulders.

"Training wheels, nigga."

I strode toward the stage, turned cleanly, and bowed. Remy played a fanfare so ridiculous I forgot to be offended. Shawna applauded with actual affection rather than the earlier rescue expression.

June said Dez had once practiced an entrance through a doorway with a jacket over one shoulder. Dez said the jacket had belonged to June, who had invented the rehearsal story to get it back.

"Did it work?" Rae asked.

"Ask the jacket," June said.

Velvet took the scarf and showed me how one small movement could look deliberate. No collision. No rented spotlight. I tried again.

Shawna crooked a finger from the front row. The rehearsal suddenly had a destination that made my extravagant entrance budget seem very poorly targeted.

Aiden's verdict. The smaller rehearsal succeeds before the full costume returns. June's jacket history remains contested, and my best entrance cue turns out to be one finger from the front row.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1014140/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P126 / A PLACE TO START

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

Edition considered: PC release

Make charming snowmen through compact spatial puzzles, if arranging a small scene is enough motivation to think through a problem.

What you do. Move around each small space and manipulate snowballs to find an arrangement that makes the intended snowman work.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed and keyboard-only declarations help, but exact movement, holding and planning demands remain worth checking.

Why it might click. A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build makes a small, affectionate premise into a spatial puzzle: a monster creating snowmen. The compact scenes invite attention to a few objects and how their positions relate. It can offer a satisfying repeated activity without needing a sprawling world or a dense inventory story.

The full catch. The current developer listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Check movement, undo and snowball manipulation on the chosen device; those declarations do not establish that every action avoids holding. The puzzles still require planning and trial, so the gentle presentation should not become a promise of effortless solutions. Narrative is limited to the charm of the activity.

Try this first. Try making one snowman and notice where your first plan changes. Learn the recovery control before treating a mistaken move as a reason to restart everything.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P126 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Snowman Had Better Posture Than the Host

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build made Kit fall in love with the idea of three rounded lanterns beside the signing table. I ordered them in gold.

Mika stacked the largest at the bottom. I suggested putting it on top for greater impact.

Rae stared at me. "Impact is exactly what I'm worried about."

The lanterns stayed in Mika's order. Remy added a little hat, and suddenly the decoration looked like a cheerful guest who had read the dress code.

June called it handsome. Dez said she had dated men with worse balance, then caught June laughing into her sleeve.

I gave the lantern guest my ceremonial sash. It wore the thing without complaining, moving, or requesting a speaking slot. Velvet suggested making it co-host.

"Nigga, I paid for him."

"And he's already doing less damage."

Shawna straightened my own jacket. We stood beside the finished arrangement for a photograph, two round-shouldered dignitaries of notably different competence.

Aiden's verdict. The lantern stack remains largest at the bottom and gains an honorary co-hosting role. I retain the microphone, but the decoration sets a demanding standard for quiet reliability.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/316610/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P127 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Cosmic Express

Edition considered: PC release

Design a tiny railway for unusual passengers, if finding a route within tight space and capacity limits sounds satisfying.

What you do. Draw or arrange tracks through the station so the train can collect and deliver its passengers in a workable order.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The puzzles are explicitly difficult; test track input despite declared untimed play and keyboard-only or mouse-only options.

Why it might click. Cosmic Express asks you to lay railway routes through small space stations and deliver their residents. The one-passenger constraint makes the order of visits important. Its appeal is the clean relationship between a visible route and the consequences that follow from it.

The full catch. The developer describes the puzzles as difficult and separately declares play without timed input, with keyboard-only and mouse-only options. Drawing tracks may still involve sustained pointer actions, so test the intended input method. Cute passengers do not reduce the planning burden: a compact station can hold a demanding puzzle. The declared input options do not certify hold-free interaction.

Try this first. Draw a route in an early station and watch one passenger's trip. Test editing or resetting the route before trying to optimize a complicated arrangement.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P127 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Cosmic Express

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Drinks Trolley Could Not Carry the Entire Coalition

Cosmic Express made route order matter on its small space stations. Our drinks trolley demonstrated the same principle by arriving at the stage with everything except room for its driver.

Tank had balanced flowers, cups, a speaker, and my ceremonial cushion on it.

"Nigga, you packed this like a hotel evacuation."

Mika separated the deliveries. First the speaker, then flowers, then drinks. Kit wanted the microphone tested before the cups appeared, which prevented Remy from attempting both jobs with one hand.

I objected to the number of trips. Rae asked how many drinks I planned to catch when the original arrangement tipped.

We made three calm journeys. On the last, Nia carried a small glass for Rae instead of adding it to the trolley. Rae accepted it with a look no transport diagram could improve.

Dez watched them and nudged June. June pretended to inspect the wheels, smiling at a mechanical feature nobody else could see.

Aiden's verdict. The trolley makes separate trips in a useful order. Nia handles one drink personally, and the transport committee declines to investigate the improvement this causes in Rae's mood.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option plus Mouse Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/583270/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P128 / A PLACE TO START

A Monster's Expedition

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a playful museum of human oddities through spatial puzzles, with discoveries and jokes giving the journey a welcoming purpose.

What you do. Explore the islands, solve environmental arrangements and investigate exhibits that offer an unusual outside view of human habits.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The charm accompanies real spatial reasoning, while movement, undo and object manipulation still need checking.

Why it might click. A Monster's Expedition combines tree-pushing spatial puzzles with comic museum observations about humanity. Small islands form a larger exploratory structure, so solving a route can lead to both a new place and a new joke. It offers a particular mix of thoughtful manipulation and dry amusement.

The full catch. The developer describes simple mechanics with substantial depth. That depth can mean difficult planning even when the action vocabulary is small. Check movement, undo, reset and the readability of the islands and exhibits. Its open structure should not be treated as proof that every puzzle is optional or that every route remains easy.

Try this first. Solve or experiment with one early crossing, then read the nearby exhibit. Judge whether the combination of puzzle and joke makes you want another island.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P128 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Monster's Expedition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Museum Put My Bad Idea on Display

A Monster's Expedition offered comic observations about human objects, so Remy created a summit museum from the equipment we had rejected.

The unattached lever occupied the central plinth. My gigantic welcome sign leaned behind it. Beside both sat the miniature signing table.

Kit wrote captions.

"Primitive host believed size created authority."

"Nigga, that is slander with good lettering."

June donated a Blue Comet jukebox token. Dez supplied a jacket button she claimed June had torn off during the famous borrowed-jacket argument. June said it had fallen naturally from a cheap seam.

Dez's eyebrows rose. "Watch yourself."

The museum drew a larger crowd than my proposed leadership display. Velvet offered to deliver the audio guide for a proper fee. I tried one recorded caption and found myself laughing halfway through.

Shawna added a photograph of the two of us beside the lantern guest. Her caption said TWO HOSTS, ONE LEARNING. I refused to ask which one had completed the course.

Aiden's verdict. The museum preserves rejected equipment and contradictory Blue Comet relics. Velvet may quote for narration, while my leadership display is absorbed into a more popular history of practical mistakes.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1052990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

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P129 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Bonfire Peaks

Edition considered: PC release

Work through spatial puzzles with a reflective theme of carrying and letting go, if that combination feels intriguing to you.

What you do. Move through puzzle spaces, arrange what you carry and examine how the next position changes the problem's possibilities.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Its voxel spaces can be demanding to reason about; exact controls and full-game timing still need checking.

Why it might click. Bonfire Peaks presents a spatial puzzle journey organized around closure and moving onward. Its compact, sculptural environments make objects and their placement visually central. It may appeal when the satisfaction of an exact arrangement is strengthened by a quiet theme about what people carry.

The full catch. The primary description promises rewarding challenges and evolving mechanics, not low difficulty. Manipulating objects in three-dimensional puzzle spaces may require careful orientation and planning. Check the actual movement and object controls before assuming the fixed-looking presentation eliminates physical demands. The emotional theme is suggestive rather than a richly voiced character drama.

Try this first. Inspect an early puzzle, learn one object interaction and test how to recover from a mistake. Continue only if the precise arrangement feels absorbing rather than burdensome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P129 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Bonfire Peaks

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / We Burned Nothing and Still Let It Go

Bonfire Peaks put closure and what people carry at the center of its puzzle journey. I looked at the pile of abandoned ceremony proposals and suggested a spectacular bonfire.

The hotel manager said no before I finished spectacular.

Dez picked up the supposedly unsigned Blue Comet agreement. June reached for it, then stopped. Both suddenly looked less interested in making jokes.

"We're not throwing that away," Dez said.

"Didn't say we were," June answered.

Rae brought a flat box. They placed the paper inside, keeping its creases and arguments intact. Mika labeled another box for rented equipment returns. My costly lever went there after a brief, unpersuasive appeal.

Shawna asked what I wanted to keep from this afternoon. I took the little photograph of us and left the gold sign behind.

"Nigga," Tank said, "growth got a return receipt."

We carried the boxes downstairs. Nothing burned. The room still felt as though somebody had opened a window.

Aiden's verdict. The old agreement is preserved, rented mistakes are returned, and no bonfire takes place. My photograph stays with me while the gold sign discovers the practical meaning of closure.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1147890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P130 / A PLACE TO START

Can of Wormholes

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a deep puzzle world with hints you can play, if learning through a smaller demonstration sounds more enjoyable than reading explanations.

What you do. Move through the puzzle situations, experiment with solutions and use playable hints to discover the underlying ideas when needed.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Explicit untimed input and unlimited undo are helpful; deeper reasoning and device-specific control comfort still matter.

Why it might click. Can of Wormholes develops many interactions from a small collection of puzzle objects. Its distinctive strength for this catalogue is a documented playable hint system: a smaller related stage can suggest the insight needed for the larger one. Experimentation and discovery are the main rewards.

The full catch. The developer explicitly states that no time-critical inputs or simultaneous key presses are required, and documents unlimited undo and restart. Those are unusually useful concrete claims. Keyboard or gamepad play is supported, with a Mac gamepad limitation noted by the developer. Spatial reasoning and learning new interactions can still be demanding; hold behavior should be checked separately.

Try this first. Try an introductory stage, use undo once and inspect a playable hint if curiosity stalls. Learn how the support works before a difficult puzzle makes it feel urgent.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P130 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Can of Wormholes

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hint Came with a Smaller Disaster

Can of Wormholes offered a playable smaller problem as a hint, which gave Rae an idea for our spectacularly tangled ribbon arch.

Instead of lecturing, she laid three short strips on a tray.

"Show me how these cross without hiding the opening."

I solved the small arrangement after two attempts. Then I looked at the full arch and finally saw what Mika had been explaining for ten minutes.

"Nigga, why didn't we start with the tray?" "We just did."

Kit tried the same little model before helping move the long ribbons. Velvet adjusted one corner for her costume. Remy tested his walk through with the microphone case.

The arch stayed decorative without becoming a curtain. I offered to teach the method to everybody else, claiming broad experience in miniature infrastructure.

Shawna handed me the tray and another three strips, this time arranged differently.

My lecture was postponed while I acquired a little more broad experience.

Aiden's verdict. The arch keeps an open passage after the small demonstration. Rae receives credit for the teaching method, and my masterclass waits until I can solve its second example.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer Steam description explicitly says no time-critical input or simultaneous key presses, unlimited undo/restart and playable hints; gamepad on Mac is not currently supported in that description. This supports the stated narrow timing claims, not universal hold-free operation.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1295320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

Dez Refused to Let the Jacket Lose on a Technicality

The costume rehearsal stopped when June noticed a loose thread at Dez's cuff. She reached for it. Dez caught her wrist gently.

"Leave it. You'll make it worse."

"I drove a bus full of people through winter. I can manage a thread."

"That's why I never let the bus hem my clothes."

Rae laughed into her drink. Nia tried not to, failed, and ended up holding the glass while Rae found a small sewing kit. Dez accepted the kit with the calm of somebody returning to familiar tools. June stayed beside her despite having several strong opinions about being supervised.

The jacket lay across both their knees. It had belonged to June first. It had spent enough time with Dez that every repair was also a small account of where it had been. Neither woman needed me to explain this, so naturally I began.

Shawna put a sandwich in my mouth.

Dez repaired the cuff. June held the little lamp at a useful angle without commenting on the appointment. Velvet came over to inspect the work and asked whether Dez would look at a loose fastening on her costume.

"For you, yes."

I offered to make the work an official heritage demonstration. Dez told me to finish chewing.

The repairs were small, exact, and almost invisible when done. They made the clothes behave better without making their wearers into examples of anything. Remy tried his stage turn nearby. Kit adjusted the light and accidentally directed it into my eyes, which everybody regarded as an acceptable temporary arrangement.

When Dez handed the jacket back to June, the room went quiet for one beat. June inspected the cuff, nodded, and helped Dez put it on again.

"There," she said.

"About time you returned it," Dez answered.

The old argument resumed before I could declare peace. Nia laughed properly this time, and Rae looked at her as if the sound had improved the room.

Mika called us back to the rehearsal route. The table still needed checking, the curtain still needed its final position, and the jacket had won the right to keep going without a plaque.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P131 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Braid, Anniversary Edition

Edition considered: PC Anniversary Edition

Explore platform puzzles that manipulate time, if clever movement challenges are appealing enough to accept their physical and timing demands.

What you do. Move through platforming spaces and use the game's time-manipulation ideas to reconsider routes, mistakes and puzzle solutions.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Rewinding does not remove timed jumps or other platforming demands, so this remains an action detour.

Why it might click. Braid, Anniversary Edition combines platform movement with puzzles built around unusual behavior of time. Its story and images concern memory, desire and regret. The new edition also includes extensive creator commentary, offering another route into the design for someone interested in how a game thinks.

The full catch. Rewinding does not remove jumping, hazards or required movement timing. The developer explicitly describes platforming and changing time mechanics. This is a conditional action-puzzle detour, not a standard no-rush fit. Check movement, jump combinations and rewind holds separately; a forgiving recovery system can reduce failure cost without reducing the action itself.

Try this first. Try one introductory movement puzzle and the rewind control. If the physical action is unwelcome, consider the design commentary as an interest to investigate rather than forcing play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P131 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Braid, Anniversary Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / You Cannot Rewind a Champagne Invoice

Braid's strange behavior of time made me wish I could rewind the instant I had ordered a champagne fountain. It was currently blocking the signing table.

I stepped backward and repeated the purchasing conversation aloud, this time making a wiser decision.

The delivery driver still wanted a signature.

"Nigga, your performance doesn't change the invoice," Velvet said.

June offered an older example of regret: lending Dez the famous jacket in 1967. Dez said the jacket had improved dramatically while absent from its owner.

Kit watched their argument, then asked whether either woman regretted the entire evening.

Both went quiet.

Mika moved the fountain to a side table and replaced its towering decoration with a small bowl. The room became workable without pretending the purchase had never happened.

Shawna took my hand and walked me forward to the chairs. I could still choose what happened next. Unfortunately, next included paying the driver before he missed his actual dinner.

Aiden's verdict. The fountain moves aside and the invoice remains in chronological order. June and Dez reserve judgment on their old evening; I practice making the next decision smaller.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/499180/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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P132 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

World of Goo

Edition considered: PC original game

Build unusual structures from connected creatures, if watching a physical construction succeed or wobble sounds like the pleasure you want.

What you do. Place and connect the available pieces, observe how the structure behaves and revise the arrangement when it fails.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Physics, precision and dragging can add pressure or sustained input; inspect the chosen level and controls directly.

Why it might click. World of Goo turns drag-and-drop construction into a physics puzzle with a comic corporate world around it. Structures bend, balance and fail in visible ways, so a small design change can be satisfying to test. Its personality comes from the creatures, signs and increasingly strange purposes of the construction work.

The full catch. The primary description explicitly says drag and drop. Holding and positioning the pointer may therefore be a central barrier. Physics unfolds while structures are running, and hazards vary by level, so do not assume an unlimited-waiting solution from the word puzzle. Check the ordinary building loop before becoming invested in the larger campaign.

Try this first. Build the smallest useful connection in an early level and watch it behave. Test selecting, dragging and releasing one piece before attempting an elaborate tower.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P132 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

World of Goo

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Garland Had Faith and No Support

World of Goo's bending constructions looked uncannily like the garland I had commissioned between two costume racks. Every new decoration made it sag closer to Remy's microphone.

I called the curve elegant.

Rae called for the hotel rigger.

The rigger gave us two sensible attachment points and removed half my decorative ambition. Velvet watched the garland settle, then selected a few pieces worth keeping. Kit arranged them where the lights could reach.

"Nigga," Tank said, "you bought enough sparkle to test gravity personally."

I suggested adding one more gold ball. The rigger looked at me without moving.

We left the ball in its box.

Remy walked beneath the finished garland and tried his fanfare. Nothing touched his head. Velvet followed with her boa, turned cleanly, and smiled at the reflection.

I finally understood the attraction of a structure doing exactly what you hoped. Then Shawna held up the unused gold ball and asked whether it was eligible for a refund.

Aiden's verdict. The garland uses proper supports and fewer ornaments. Remy and Velvet pass beneath it successfully, while the spare gold ball awaits a financial miracle more demanding than gravity.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/22000/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P133 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

World of Goo 2

Edition considered: PC sequel

Try new construction and liquid puzzles within World of Goo's satirical world, if experimenting with physical systems sounds entertaining.

What you do. Arrange the available elements, observe their physical behavior and revise the construction to make the current situation work.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. New physical systems can increase demands; check pointer precision, dragging and scene-specific timing before treating it as relaxed.

Why it might click. World of Goo 2 expands the construction idea with flowing liquid, new material behaviors and another satirical corporate story. The attraction is watching a designed structure interact with a physical process, then discovering a better arrangement. It is a distinct sequel with new puzzles rather than an alternative edition of the first game.

The full catch. The developer describes a dangerous world and varied material mechanics. Pointer precision, holding or dragging, moving liquid and level-specific hazards need assessment. Do not assume that familiarity with one type of goo makes the complete game mechanically simple. This is most plausible when hands-on construction is itself enjoyable, not merely a route to the jokes.

Try this first. Try one early construction problem and observe how one material behaves. Check whether editing the structure feels comfortable before attempting to manage several interactions at once.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P133 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

World of Goo 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Sequel Introduced Liquid to My Bad Idea

World of Goo 2 brought new material behavior to its construction puzzles. I brought liquid to our stage problem by proposing a decorative water channel around the signing table.

Mika loved it for three seconds, which was three seconds longer than Rae.

"Nigga, where do the cables go?"

I drew a very optimistic bridge.

Velvet asked where her train went. Kit asked where the chairs went. Tank asked whether the water was drinkable, then lost interest when it wasn't.

Mika erased their initial sketch and designed a reflection using a shallow decorative bowl well away from the equipment. The hotel technician approved its location. Mercedes tested the lights above it.

The effect looked almost exactly like the expensive thing I had imagined, except nobody had to step over my imagination to reach a chair.

I claimed collaboration had refined the vision. Shawna wrote DOWNGRADED MOAT on the back of the original drawing and slipped it into Remy's museum.

Aiden's verdict. The proposed moat becomes a modest reflection away from equipment and walking routes. Remy's museum receives another drawing, this one documenting the brief naval phase of my stage design.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/3385670/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P134 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

HUMANITY

Edition considered: PC non-VR mode proposed for assessment

Direct striking crowds through puzzle spaces as a dog, if the unusual spectacle appeals alongside more active stages and challenges.

What you do. Guide crowds through environments, place or use directions and respond to the puzzle and action situations along the route.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Action, platforming and bosses are documented, so the crowd-routing premise does not make the whole game untimed.

Why it might click. HUMANITY turns crowd direction into a striking puzzle-action spectacle. A dog places commands that shape the movement of many people, making routes and group behavior visible at a large scale. Its visual ideas may appeal to someone who enjoys watching a small instruction transform a complex scene.

The full catch. The developer explicitly includes action-focused stages, platform-like elements and boss battles. This prevents an unqualified no-rush recommendation. Navigation, command placement and the behavior of moving crowds need checking, and the ordinary-screen version should be assessed separately from VR. A clever planning premise does not remove required reactions elsewhere.

Try this first. Inspect an introductory routing stage and test one command. Treat later action sections as a real selection barrier, not a detail to discover after making a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P134 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

HUMANITY

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dog Was Better at Crowd Direction

HUMANITY's dog directing crowds made me wonder whether our rehearsal needed fewer speeches and clearer instructions. This was an unpleasant idea because speeches were my principal contribution.

Mika asked everyone to try the entrance once.

I stood beside the arch and delivered a stirring welcome. Behind me, Kit and Velvet approached the same narrow corner from opposite directions.

Rae raised her hand. Everybody stopped before the costumes touched.

"Nigga, your speech is parked in the road."

We moved my position and marked a simple waiting place with a chair. Remy tried the entrance, then Nia and Rae. June took her time and chatted with Dez halfway through. The route still worked.

I asked whether we should increase the pace for dramatic effect.

Mika shook their head. "The effect is people arriving."

Tank applauded the last crossing with a bread roll in each hand. No grand instruction followed. We had successfully transported the coalition approximately twenty feet without losing a delegate to my introduction.

Aiden's verdict. The entrance rehearsal keeps clear waiting space and ordinary pace. My speech moves out of the path, permitting delegates to arrive without navigating around the ceremonial meaning of arrival.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1581480/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P135 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

COCOON

Edition considered: PC release

Explore worlds nested inside portable worlds, if that spatial invention is compelling enough to consider a game with guardian encounters.

What you do. Carry and use world-orbs, move between their environments and work out how the nested spaces relate to each other.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Guardian battles are a concrete action barrier; also check movement and world-handling controls before committing to the journey.

Why it might click. COCOON builds an alien puzzle adventure around worlds contained within portable orbs. Carrying a world into another world changes what can be done, creating a strong visual form of discovery. The appeal is the elegant connection between an object, a place and a new possibility.

The full catch. The official description explicitly includes guardian battles with new mechanics. A small-looking action vocabulary therefore does not prove a no-reaction experience. Check movement, aiming or triggering abilities, required timing and the effect of failure. This is a narrow puzzle-adventure detour for someone interested in those interactions, not a default quiet-game recommendation.

Try this first. Try the first world-and-orb interaction to see whether its logic feels satisfying. Preview a representative guardian encounter before assuming that the opening describes the full game.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P135 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

COCOON

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Mika Put the Ballroom Inside a Snow Globe

COCOON's worlds within portable orbs made Mika hold up their newest model: a tiny ballroom inside a clear sphere. They wanted it on the signing table.

I wanted it on a revolving pedestal.

Rae wanted enough table left for hands.

We tested the sphere beside the paper. Nia leaned in to write and bumped it with her sleeve. The ballroom rolled majestically toward Tank, who caught an entire civilization against his stomach.

"Nigga, this world needs a flat bottom."

Mika fetched a stand. Velvet moved the sphere to a separate display, where its little stage looked more impressive without competing with the actual one.

Kit peered inside and found miniature chairs facing a miniature portrait. She turned the portrait toward the wall.

I demanded respect for scale.

Shawna held up the globe so I could inspect the correction. Inside, a tiny unobstructed table waited for imaginary guests. I had to admit the world within our world had improved.

Aiden's verdict. The model ballroom stays in a stable display beside the ceremony. Its miniature portrait faces the wall until I produce evidence that tiny guests enjoy being watched while writing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1497440/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P136 / A PLACE TO START

Gorogoa

Edition considered: PC release

Discover surprising connections between illustrated panels, if rearranging pictures into something newly meaningful sounds like a satisfying kind of puzzle.

What you do. Move or arrange illustrated panels, inspect their details and follow the relationships that emerge when images connect differently.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Panel dragging and exact pointer control need checking; visual calm does not establish hold-free interaction.

Why it might click. Gorogoa tells its story through illustrated panels that the player arranges and combines. Its puzzles depend on visual relationships, scale and the possibility that one image can become part of another. The result can feel like discovering how a picture thinks rather than manipulating a conventional inventory.

The full catch. Panel movement and visual precision are the main checks. The store supports arranging and combining images, but not a complete hold-free control claim. Inspect whether dragging, zooming or small targets are comfortable on the chosen device. The story is largely visual and interpretive, which may be appealing or may feel less concrete than dialogue-led mysteries.

Try this first. Move or inspect one panel in the opening arrangement and watch for a new relationship. Focus on that single change before trying to explain the whole story.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P136 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Gorogoa

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Windows Made a Picture My Face Could Not Improve

Gorogoa's illustrated panels made Mercedes suggest a backdrop composed of separate framed scenes. Kit found old window frames in the hotel's prop store. Mika arranged them on approved stands. I brought four photographs of myself. Mercedes turned them facedown. She used a courtyard sketch, a photograph of June and Dez's jukebox token, a corner of the venue map, and a blank panel that caught the room's reflection. From one angle they looked unrelated. From another, the doorway in the sketch met the real doorway beyond it. Velvet stepped into the reflected panel and stopped. "Oh. That's mine." Then Remy appeared beside her, ruining the solemnity with a grin. She elbowed him gently out of her light. "Nigga," I said, "the art keeps changing." Shawna stood beside me in the reflection. Mercedes adjusted one frame, and the background suddenly included everybody carrying chairs instead of just the people posing. I put my photographs back in the envelope. **Aiden's verdict.** The backdrop combines separate views and leaves space for whoever crosses its reflection. Mercedes rejects four host portraits, preserving the room's ability to show more than its purchaser.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed. Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/557600/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P137 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

Explore impossible-looking architecture through a visual puzzle journey, if changing perspective and opening a path sounds appealing to you.

What you do. Inspect each architectural scene and manipulate its structures to create a route through the changing arrangement of shapes.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Pushing, pulling and clicking need a hold-and-drag check on this PC edition, despite its approachable presentation.

Why it might click. Monument Valley guides Ida through compact architectural illusions. Manipulating parts of the monuments changes which paths connect, giving visual discovery a clear purpose. The Panoramic PC presentation can suit someone drawn to beautiful, contained spaces rather than a freely steered open world.

The full catch. The developer describes pushing, pulling, clicking, raising and lowering parts of the scenery. Those operations need a hold-and-drag check; the game's approachable marketing is not a control guarantee. The current Steam header uses Monument Valley, while its description explicitly identifies the Panoramic edition. Keep that edition scope when checking settings and input.

Try this first. Complete one early architectural transformation and send Ida along the new path. Test the manipulation itself before deciding that the quiet presentation matches the desired physical comfort.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P137 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Staircase Worked Beautifully in the Photograph

Monument Valley's impossible-looking paths encouraged Mika to angle two stage panels so a staircase appeared to continue into the painted backdrop.

The illusion was gorgeous. I announced that visitors could ascend into symbolic unity.

Rae put a hand on my chest before I demonstrated.

"Nigga, that's paint."

Kit laughed so hard she lost her glasses again. Dez found them on the table and used one arm as a pointer while explaining exactly where my symbolic foot would have gone.

We marked the painted staircase as scenery and kept the real path beside it. Velvet tried the view from the audience, then chose the spot where her silver costume made the architecture look even stranger.

Mika took a photograph. I stood on the actual floor with Shawna and pointed upward as if we had commissioned the laws of perspective.

Remy called it a magnificent ascent. Rae called it two people staying where the stage technician had told them.

Aiden's verdict. The architectural illusion remains scenery, with the real path clearly separate. Velvet claims its best photographic angle, and my symbolic ascent is completed entirely on the actual floor.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927720. Current header shortens the name, but detailed description explicitly identifies Panoramic Edition and manipulation actions. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Holds/timing not certified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927720/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P138 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

Follow a story of care and independence through architectural puzzles, if the relationship gives the changing spaces a stronger reason to explore.

What you do. Guide the journey through changing structures and manipulate the architecture as the relationship between the two travelers develops.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging; check held movement, targets and recovery from mistakes.

Why it might click. Monument Valley 2 connects architectural illusion with a story of Ro and her child. The changing paths give its themes of care and independence a visual form. The developer describes it as a standalone adventure, so interest in this relationship does not require finishing the first game.

The full catch. The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging to reshape the world. That is a concrete conditional barrier, even though the presentation is calm. Check how long manipulations must be held, target size and recovery from an unintended movement. The current storefront's shorter title still identifies the Panoramic edition in its detailed description.

Try this first. Try one early interaction involving the two travelers and the structure around them. Assess the drag action before assuming that a gentle story means physically effortless play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P138 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Auntie June Let Dez Find Her Own Spotlight

Monument Valley 2's journey of care and independence arrived at exactly the wrong moment for June to direct Dez's rehearsal entrance.

"Left," June said. Dez went right.

"The good light is left."

"The woman wearing this jacket is right."

I offered to resolve the disagreement with a third spotlight. Velvet told me to let the entrance happen before renting a galaxy.

Dez walked to the position she preferred and looked back. June had stopped giving instructions. She was holding the old Blue Comet button between two fingers, smiling despite herself.

Kit moved the light slightly. The jacket caught it beautifully.

"Nigga, you could've just asked," Rae told me when I began claiming credit for the compromise.

I asked Shawna where she wanted to stand in our photograph. She chose a place I had not considered. I joined her there and discovered my own best side was apparently wherever she had decided to laugh.

Aiden's verdict. Dez chooses her place and Kit adjusts the light around the actual entrance. June keeps the button, while I learn to ask where Shawna wants to stand.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927740. Detailed text identifies Panoramic Edition and explicitly describes clicking and dragging. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Calm presentation is not a hold-free guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927740/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P139 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room

Edition considered: PC original game

Investigate an elaborate puzzle box, if noticing small details and uncovering a mechanism feels more inviting than navigating a large world.

What you do. Inspect the box closely, examine its details and manipulate mechanisms to discover what the object is concealing.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Turning, zooming and dragging remain unresolved comfort checks; the primary premise does not certify a fully untimed route.

Why it might click. The Room offers close inspection of elaborate mechanical objects within an atmospheric mystery. Cryptic letters and unusual devices give each discovered mechanism a little narrative weight. Its concentrated setting may appeal more than walking through a large world, especially when the desired activity is examining something with a purpose.

The full catch. Close-up object puzzles can demand rotation, zooming, sliding and held pointer movement. The primary PC description calls the experience tactile but does not certify click-only controls. Check a representative latch or dial and the readability of details. The eerie tone may also matter even if the player is not controlling a combat character.

Try this first. Inspect the first object, identify one movable part and test the exact interaction. Learn how to leave a close-up before proceeding through several layers.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P139 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Pen Came in a Box with an Attitude

The Room's elaborate mechanical objects gave the pen supplier ideas nobody had authorized. Our ceremonial pen arrived inside a polished box with sliding panels and no obvious opening.

Rae wanted a pen. I wanted an unveiling.

Kit examined the seams while Remy read the enclosed letter in his deepest stage voice. Velvet asked whether the box contained wages.

"No." "Then lower the voice."

Mika found the simple catch underneath. The lid opened before I could finish describing the mystery. Inside lay a perfectly ordinary pen on far too much velvet.

Nia tried it on scrap paper. Her handwriting remained spectacularly terrible.

"Nigga," Rae said, smiling, "we spent all that money to reveal a problem we already knew."

I offered the pen another unveiling in better light. Shawna handed Nia a second sheet instead.

She wrote slowly this time. Rae could read her own name. Nobody else got to ask why that was the practice word.

Aiden's verdict. The ornate box opens and the ordinary pen writes. Nia practices on scrap paper, while the supplier's dramatic packaging is denied a separate appearance in the ceremony.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/288160/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P140 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room Two

Edition considered: PC release

Continue The Room's mechanical mystery in broader spaces, if examining objects remains enjoyable and a larger investigation sounds welcome.

What you do. Investigate objects and mechanisms, follow the scientist's letters and connect discoveries across the spaces presented by the game.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Expanded environments add location and object memory, while turning, zooming and dragging still need a PC-specific check.

Why it might click. The Room Two continues the series' mechanical mystery while expanding the spaces and objects to investigate. Following an enigmatic scientist's letters gives the tactile puzzle work a thread to pursue. It may suit someone who liked the first game's close observation and wants a broader version of that activity.

The full catch. An expanded environment can add object and location memory to the familiar manipulation demands. Check turning, zooming, dragging and moving between viewpoints in the PC release rather than carrying over assumptions from a mobile version. The primary source establishes a rebuilt PC edition, not universal comfort or a completely untimed completion path.

Try this first. Investigate one object in the opening area and complete a single interaction chain. Notice whether finding the next relevant object feels inviting or starts to become visual clutter.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P140 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room Two

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Second Box Had the First Box's Instructions

The Room Two was expanding its mechanical mystery just as a second package arrived from our pen supplier. I accepted it with the confidence of a man already defeated by one small catch.

Inside were instructions for opening the first box.

Tank looked from the paper to the open lid. "Nigga, the sequel arrived late."

Remy offered to read the instructions as a tragic monologue. Velvet requested a comic one and named her fee for laughing on cue.

Kit sorted the useful paper from the promotional nonsense. Mika found a proper diagram for changing the pen cartridge, which we kept near the spare.

June watched Dez test the pen. "You could've signed in sixty-seven with that."

"I could've signed with anything. You wouldn't stop changing the song."

They looked at each other, neither reaching for the old agreement. Rae returned the new pen to its easy-open tray. The present ceremony did not need to solve every old argument before having working equipment.

Aiden's verdict. The useful cartridge diagram stays with the spare pen. Remy's instruction monologue is deferred, and the new ceremony remains equipped without pretending to conclude the Blue Comet dispute.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/425580/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

The Camera Did Not Get to Name Everybody

The photographer arrived during the costume check and asked where he should put the men.

Remy raised one hand. Tank raised a bread roll. I stepped into the best light on instinct.

The photographer pointed at Velvet, Kit, and Rae.

"Also you three. The masculine side of the group."

Velvet looked down at her silver costume, then back at him.

"Baby, if this is your idea of masculine, I need to see what you wore to work yesterday."

His name was Owen. He was an adult gay man hired by the hotel, which he told us immediately, as if the information might excuse the photograph before he took it. It did not make him a villain. It also did not arrange anybody's feet.

"I meant the presentation," he said.

"Then ask about the picture you want," Remy said. "Don't assign people a whole life to get a balanced triangle."

I offered to form the triangle around myself. Shawna moved me two feet to the left and improved the conversation.

Owen lowered the camera and claimed he had meant to separate sharp tailoring from flowing costumes. Velvet looked down at the dress he had put on the tailored side. Even his excuse needed rearranging.

Kit considered the new proposal. She was willing to stand beside the silver costume. Rae wanted to remain beside Nia. Velvet wanted the light slightly higher. Remy wanted his name used when he was not performing.

These requests did not require a tribunal. Owen listened, adjusted, and began again.

The fees were already protected by the earlier budget argument. I thought that meant the photograph would be easy. Then the hotel's sponsorship coordinator arrived with an opinion nobody had purchased.

Martin was an adult straight man with a cheerful voice and the confidence of somebody accustomed to explaining what would appeal to everyone. He asked whether the photograph could look a little less like a drag show and more like a coalition.

Velvet folded one arm across the other.

"What do you think a coalition looks like?"

"A broader group."

"You're looking at one."

He said he meant the general public. Rae asked which people in the room had ceased to be members of it when they put their clothes on.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

I enjoyed that question so much I nearly repeated it into the microphone. Nia took the microphone off its stand and passed it to Remy before I could turn somebody else's irritation into my own grand moment.

Martin tried to clarify. He wanted the picture to look welcoming. The glitter, the posture, the deliberate styling might appear confrontational to some guests.

Kit glanced at Rae. This time she did not rush to explain Rae's expression for her.

Rae said, "Which posture?"

Martin looked at the camera rather than at her. "I'm not singling anybody out."

"You're already choosing who counts as the public. Tell us who gets left out."

The room became quiet. Owen set his camera on the table.

Martin admitted that he had asked Rae to soften her expression during an earlier test shot. He had described Kit's equally serious face as strong. Hearing the two instructions together embarrassed him more effectively than anything I could have purchased.

Rae did not smile to reward the admission.

"I don't need to perform friendly twice as hard so your brochure can feel relaxed."

Kit looked at her own test image. "And I don't want my picture used as the reasonable version of hers."

June gave a short approving noise from the front row. Then she told both younger women that neither was required to keep a serious expression out of principle if something was funny.

"Nigga, don't let the photographer steal your laugh just because you won't sell it."

Rae laughed at that, which was June's joke earning a response, not Martin's request finally being obeyed.

Owen asked whether everyone wanted a break before the group photograph. Rae said yes. Velvet said she wanted her individual stage pictures first, under the terms already agreed. Kit went to find her glasses. Remy tested the microphone with a joke so bad Martin laughed before remembering he was in trouble.

"You're allowed," Remy told him. "The joke's terrible for everybody."

During the break, Kit sat beside Velvet and asked whether she got tired of having every elaborate outfit treated as a declaration about her entire existence.

Velvet removed one earring. "Sometimes I want it to be a declaration. Sometimes I want you to notice I paid somebody to sew the damn hem."

"How do people know which?"

"They can ask a question smaller than what are you."

Velvet remembered one gay club booking where a man who called her family had then asked her to work for less. Another man at the same club had quietly fixed the payment before the show. She liked remembering both, especially because neither account let anybody use belonging as a discount code.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Kit nodded. She talked about enjoying a good jacket without wanting it interpreted as either a failure to be a woman or a promise to behave like a man. Rae joined them but did not simply echo her. She liked the word stud. It connected to a Black lesbian world she recognized, to people and style and ways of carrying herself that were not available for anybody else's casual relabeling.

"I like what we recognise in each other. I don't want to make your word mine," Kit said.

"Good. I like what we share," Rae said. "I'm still going to tell you when you get me wrong."

June leaned forward. "And leave room for an old Black butch. Some of us were here before your categories got assigned hotel rooms."

Dez touched her sleeve. "You were here before the chairs."

"Still more comfortable than that first jukebox stool."

The room laughed, then returned to the conversation without making either veteran an honorary textbook.

Remy unfastened the small crown from his costume. As King Receipts he could make himself grander, louder, and deliberately ridiculous. As Remy he wanted his date to know he was nervous about the flowers.

"I don't stop being me when the crown comes off," he said. "I just stop charging the room interest."

Velvet snorted. "Keep that one. It almost worked."

Nia asked Rae whether she liked being seen as protective. Rae considered the question.

"Sometimes. When I choose it. I like taking care of people. I also like somebody noticing I'm tired before handing me another box."

Nia set down the box she had been about to offer.

"Oh."

"That one was funny."

They smiled, but the question stayed useful. Caring could be pleasure. It could also become a job people assigned by looking at a body, a jacket, a voice, or the person standing beside it. Rae did not want her tenderness denied. She wanted the right to decide what she did with it.

Kit admitted that she sometimes enjoyed being read as competent before she had earned it. The temptation was especially strong when an event already treated her confidence as less alarming than Rae's. She could not fix that by pretending nobody noticed race, or by claiming Rae's experiences as another version of her own.

"I can stop accepting the comparison as a compliment," she said.

"That's a start," Rae answered. "It doesn't require me to grade the rest of your life."

Owen returned and asked whether they wanted the arrangement kept or changed. He did not call the room boys, girls, masculine, feminine, or brave. He used names. Martin stayed beside him and listened while Mika explained what the picture was for: a record of this evening, not proof that every person outside it would approve.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Mika set one further condition: each person could approve the photograph and caption before the hotel posted either. Nia added that declining the picture would not mean declining the coalition. Martin wrote that down. It was a smaller promise than universal welcome, and one he could actually keep.

I offered to put a political declaration beneath the photograph.

Nia asked which declaration.

"Something powerful."

"Then know what you mean before ordering the lettering."

Shawna rescued me with a more demanding assignment: stand beside her and look as if I wanted to be there.

We made the picture with Rae next to Nia, Kit near Velvet, Remy holding his crown rather than wearing it, and June and Dez comfortably seated. Some people smiled. Some did not. The photographer took more than one image so nobody had to become the single official expression of an identity.

Afterward, Velvet put her earring back on and asked Owen for the stage light she had originally requested. He adjusted it without explaining himself again.

"Nigga," she said to me, "now watch the entrance."

She stepped through the curtain. The room belonged to her for that moment because she knew exactly what she was doing, and because the rest of us finally had the sense to look.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P141 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room Three

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate a mysterious island and its intricate mechanisms, if a larger setting makes the invitation to examine objects more compelling.

What you do. Explore the presented spaces, inspect mechanisms and follow clues through the trials associated with the elusive Craftsman.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. More navigation and location memory join close manipulation; dragging, holds and full-game timing remain to be checked.

Why it might click. The Room Three expands mechanical puzzle investigation into a mysterious island and the trials of an elusive Craftsman. Its rebuilt PC presentation offers richly detailed objects and spaces. This is a candidate for someone who enjoys handling intricate mysteries and wants a broader setting around the mechanisms.

The full catch. Broader spaces can increase navigation and remembered-location demands. Close manipulation still needs an exact-device check for turning, dragging and zooming; a mouse interface does not establish that everything is click-only. The inspected description does not certify every later interaction as untimed. Eerie isolation is part of the appeal, so choose it for that mood rather than assuming the title means a quiet decorating game.

Try this first. Inspect the first available mechanism and follow one clue to its consequence. Check manipulation comfort before treating the island's larger mysteries as a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P141 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room Three

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Craftsman Had Gone to Lunch

The Room Three's elusive Craftsman had a local equivalent: the hotel carpenter, who had completed our small platform repair and then gone to lunch.

I needed him to approve an additional ornamental arch.

Mika pointed to the completed inspection note. The existing arrangement worked. The extra arch existed only in my expanding imagination.

"Nigga, can't the man eat?" Tank asked.

I described the arch's mysterious significance. Velvet described the practical significance of getting her costume onto the finished stage before nightfall.

Remy tried the microphone position. Kit tested the entrance light. Rae sat at the table and reached the pen without moving a vase. All three actions succeeded, leaving me nothing useful to announce.

The carpenter returned carrying a sandwich. I began my pitch.

He looked at the clear stage, looked at my sketch, and asked what problem the arch solved.

Shawna answered before I could. "He can still see an empty space." The carpenter finished his sandwich in peace.

Aiden's verdict. The approved stage stays as built, and the carpenter keeps his lunch break. My additional arch is filed under problems created by noticing that air occupies no invoice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/456750/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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P142 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room 4: Old Sins

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a dollhouse concealing a darker domestic mystery, if detailed rooms and their connections make you want to understand what happened.

What you do. Investigate the dollhouse's rooms, manipulate tactile contraptions and follow the disappearance story through objects and their relationships.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Room switching and object uses add memory work; turning, dragging and complete-path timing remain unverified.

Why it might click. Old Sins frames its mechanical puzzles around an unusual dollhouse and a disappearance at Waldegrave Manor. An engineer, his wife and a sought-after artifact give the investigation a darker domestic story. The PC edition rebuilds the visual presentation around detailed rooms and their interconnections.

The full catch. The dollhouse is a mysterious adult setting, not evidence of simple mechanics. Moving among rooms and tracking object uses can add memory demands; rotating and manipulating mechanisms may involve sustained pointer actions. Check the PC controls directly. The reviewed source establishes the premise and tactile puzzles, but leaves full-game timing and hold requirements unresolved.

Try this first. Explore one dollhouse area and identify what changed after a single mechanism. Continue if the relationship between the small room and the larger mystery feels satisfying.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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P142 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room 4: Old Sins

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dollhouse Exposed My Dressing-Room Plans

The Room 4's dollhouse mystery made Mika's model hotel the center of attention again. They had built little versions of the dressing rooms so everyone could test the arrangement.

I had quietly enlarged my own.

Rae lifted the roof. My suite occupied half the model. Velvet's costume rack stood in a space roughly equal to one shoe.

"Nigga, whose disappearance we investigating? The other rooms?"

Kit moved the dividing walls. Remy added a miniature chair near the mirror. Nia placed the quiet room back where the venue annex had agreed it belonged.

I protested that the model was an artistic interpretation. Mika handed me the real measurements. Shawna examined our suddenly smaller suite and nodded. "Still room for what we need."

I became much less interested in square footage.

Velvet tested the improved dressing space with a folded paper stand-in for her boa. It turned cleanly. The dollhouse investigation closed with all rooms found and my secret extension removed.

Aiden's verdict. The dollhouse returns to the agreed measurements, restoring useful dressing space and the quiet room. My unauthorized extension disappears, while Shawna confirms our smaller suite remains entirely sufficient.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1361320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

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P143 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The House of Da Vinci

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate Leonardo's disappearance through Renaissance machinery, if a fictional historical mystery gives mechanical puzzles a more compelling reason to solve them.

What you do. Inspect the workshop's objects, solve mechanical puzzles and use unusual devices to examine the environment in different ways.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Small details, object memory, viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation need checking; a point-and-click label does not eliminate holds.

Why it might click. As Leonardo's apprentice, investigate his disappearance through mechanical puzzles and hidden objects in a Renaissance setting. Special devices add unusual ways to inspect the environment. The appeal is fictional intrigue joined to elaborate machinery, with an atmosphere inspired by historical inventions rather than a plain sequence of abstract boards.

The full catch. Inspecting objects can involve viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation; do not assume that a point-and-click label eliminates dragging or holds. Puzzles may require noticing small details and remembering where a device belongs. The source describes a fictional adventure, not a history lesson or a verified fully untimed control path. Test the intended PC input arrangement.

Try this first. Examine one early device and identify its moving parts before trying to solve everything nearby. Check whether manipulating it feels pleasant enough to support a longer mystery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

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P143 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The House of Da Vinci

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Leonardo Would Have Asked Where the Screws Went

The House of Da Vinci made me want the ceremony to display invention, so I purchased a wooden mechanism that raised a small curtain when a wheel turned.

Rae unpacked it and asked where the screws were.

"Perhaps concealed for discovery."

"Perhaps missing, nigga."

Kit examined the delivery checklist. Remy found the hardware packet inside the decorative wheel. Mika called the hotel technician before anyone attempted an inspired reconstruction.

While we waited, Dez showed June a neat repair she had made to the old jacket lining. June touched the seam and stopped arguing for a whole minute. I nearly rented a spotlight for the occasion.

The technician assembled the curtain device and demonstrated its modest movement. No Renaissance conspiracy. No vanished genius. Just a little curtain that opened when asked.

Velvet tried it and approved the timing of her reveal. Rae put the spare screws in a labeled bag. I called that archival practice because I still needed a dignified contribution.

Aiden's verdict. The small curtain mechanism is assembled by the technician, with spare hardware kept nearby. Velvet approves the reveal, and I supply an impressive name for putting screws in a bag.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/522470/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P144 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The House of Da Vinci 2

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a narrated Renaissance mystery where actions connect past and present, if discovering consequences across time sounds interesting to you.

What you do. Investigate mechanisms, listen to the story and use the time-related device to understand connections between earlier and present conditions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Redesigned controls are not proof of low demand, and multiple time relationships can add substantial remembering work.

Why it might click. The second House of Da Vinci combines Renaissance mystery, mechanical puzzles and a device that connects past actions with present conditions. The developer describes a fully narrated story and redesigned controls. Those are useful distinctions to check when choosing this installment, particularly if hearing the narrative is part of its appeal.

The full catch. Redesigned controls are not proof of low physical demand. Test the actual manipulation, viewpoint changes and dragging on the PC version. Time travel can increase the number of relationships to remember, and narration does not guarantee that every clue is spoken. The reviewed source does not settle all later timed interactions or the option to avoid sustained input.

Try this first. Try one narrated scene and one mechanical interaction. Notice separately whether the voices help the story and whether the device controls feel comfortable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P144 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The House of Da Vinci 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Past Had Installed the Curtain Backward

The House of Da Vinci 2's connection between past actions and present conditions felt personal when we discovered why the ceremonial curtain kept catching.

Yesterday, I had asked the installer to reverse it so the embroidered crest faced the camera.

Today, the pull ran behind the furniture. "Nigga, your past self owes us labor," Rae said.

I offered to apologize to yesterday. Mika asked me to help move the chair instead.

We restored the original arrangement. Remy read the brief equipment instructions aloud while Kit checked the sightline. Velvet tested the reveal again and emerged at exactly the right place with a magnificent expression of being worth all this trouble.

She was.

Shawna asked whether I had learned anything about giving last-minute artistic directions. I said future Aiden would be exceptionally careful.

She handed me the chair. "Present Aiden can finish."

I carried it back, discovering that time travel remained unnecessary for encountering the consequences of my own decorative taste.

Aiden's verdict. The curtain returns to its intended arrangement and Velvet's reveal works. Past Aiden receives no exemption, future Aiden receives no advance praise, and present Aiden carries the chair.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1259840/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P145 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The House of Da Vinci 3

Edition considered: PC release

Continue Giacomo's Renaissance adventure through conspiracies and machinery, if the series' characters and atmosphere already make its conclusion appealing to you.

What you do. Follow the concluding story, inspect mechanical puzzles and investigate the time-related mysteries surrounding Giacomo and Leonardo's journey together.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Finale context, manipulation and viewpoint controls make this conditional; full-route timing is not verified by the reviewed source.

Why it might click. The third game concludes Giacomo's adventure with Leonardo, combining mechanical puzzles, time-related mysteries and conspiracies across Italian settings. The developer advertises voiced historical figures within the fictional story. It is most appealing as a continuation for someone already enjoying the series' machinery and atmosphere.

The full catch. A finale can carry more narrative context than a first encounter needs. Its polished presentation and claims of intuitive interaction do not verify click-only play or absence of required holds. Check the PC manipulation and camera behavior, and establish whether prior story knowledge matters to the intended experience. Full-route timing remains unverified in this source pass.

Try this first. Watch or inspect the opening premise without racing onward. If the characters and controls are already familiar, try one mechanism; otherwise consider starting with the first installment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P145 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The House of Da Vinci 3

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Third Revelation Was a Working Light Switch

The House of Da Vinci 3 was concluding an elaborate adventure while our own three-part curtain saga approached its final revelation: the lamp behind it had never been switched on.

I had blamed atmosphere. Kit found the plug.

Remy requested a voiced announcement of the discovery. Velvet told him to save his best voice for the actual entrance, then winked when he tried a ridiculous royal whisper anyway.

"Nigga, one more sequel and this curtain gets its own dressing room," Tank said.

June and Dez sat side by side watching the test. When the light came up, Dez's repaired jacket shimmered at the cuff. June quietly straightened it before anybody took a photograph.

I saw the gesture and kept my mouth shut. Shawna noticed me noticing. She squeezed my hand once.

The final test worked from beginning to end. Curtain, light, entrance, microphone. Four ordinary things, all cooperating. I almost hated how much better it looked than a mystery.

Aiden's verdict. The curtain sequence concludes with a working light and a clear entrance. Remy's royal whisper remains optional, while the equipment declines my proposal to commission a fourth installment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1603640/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P146 / A PLACE TO START

Carto

Edition considered: PC release

Help Carto find her grandmother by rearranging the map itself, if changing geography sounds like a playful way to solve a journey.

What you do. Rearrange map pieces to create paths, then move through the changed world and meet people along the route.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Map manipulation and character movement are separate activities; check dragging, rotation and held movement before settling in.

Why it might click. Carto combines a journey to reunite with Granny with puzzles that rearrange the map itself. Changing the arrangement creates new paths and possibilities in the world. Friendly encounters and varied communities give the spatial puzzle a human thread, offering more story context than an isolated logic board.

The full catch. There are two activities to learn: moving the character and manipulating map pieces. Check rotation, placement, any dragging and the amount of direction holding needed for walking. The peaceful presentation is encouraging, but it does not establish every interaction as untimed or effortless. Later map relationships may demand more spatial reasoning than the first examples suggest.

Try this first. Complete one map change, then walk the resulting route and notice what it changed. Judge whether switching between map thinking and character movement feels natural.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P146 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Carto

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / We Could Move the Map Before Moving the Piano

Carto's rearranged map gave Mika a useful way to explain the stage problem. They shifted two paper room shapes and opened a straight route from the dressing area to the microphone.

I preferred the previous arrangement because my portrait faced the entrance.

Rae slid the portrait symbol aside. The route improved further.

"Nigga, the map's discovering freedom."

Kit placed a paper piano near the stage. Mercedes moved it closer to the power supply and asked whether anyone had checked the actual clearance before carrying anything heavy.

We had not. We did.

The revised arrangement worked, though it cost me a little symmetry. Remy pushed two empty chairs through first. Velvet followed with the boa over one arm. Nobody struck the piano, the mirror, or each other's patience.

Shawna drew a tiny heart beside our seats. I left it there instead of adding a host emblem. Some changes to a map made the place feel more like somewhere I wanted to go.

Aiden's verdict. The paper arrangement is tested before the piano moves. The portrait yields its preferred angle, and Shawna's small heart remains the only symbol I decline to enlarge.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1172450/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P147 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Chants of Sennaar

Edition considered: PC release

Decode languages and discover a divided tower's peoples, if understanding symbols is appealing enough to consider the adventure's separate stealth demands.

What you do. Observe conversations and scenes, record meanings in the notebook and revise symbol interpretations while traveling through the tower.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Developer-confirmed guard timing conflicts with a strict no-rush route, despite useful mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations.

Why it might click. Chants of Sennaar builds a tower journey around interpreting several interconnected languages. Observation, conversations and a notebook of symbols support the process of finding meaning. Its distinctive appeal is the moment when a scene becomes understandable, with communication across separated peoples supplying a larger purpose.

The full catch. The developer explicitly confirms stealth sections that require choosing a path and timing movement around guard patterns. This conflicts with a strict no-rush route. The Steam listing's mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations do not remove that demand, and the developer says the gamepad cover/free toggle does not apply to mouse-and-keyboard play. Language deduction also adds substantial memory work.

Try this first. Explore the early language puzzle only if that bounded visit is wanted. Preview the stealth requirements before committing; do not promise that enjoying the opening makes the full game suitable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P147 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Chants of Sennaar

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Coalition Needed Words Beside the Symbols

Chants of Sennaar had us considering how meaning travels between people while Remy designed the ceremony's cue cards entirely in symbols.

A crown meant begin. A moon meant pause. A little bird meant something he had already forgotten. Velvet held up the bird. "Fly away from this proposal?"

Kit added ordinary words beneath each image. Nia checked that the wording matched what people had agreed. Rae asked whether pause could mean an actual pause instead of a dramatic inhalation. It could.

June studied the crown. She said Dez had once used a similar doodle on the disputed Blue Comet agreement. Dez said it had been a badly drawn jukebox.

"Nigga, this is why we need labels," Tank said.

Remy wrote BEGIN, PAUSE, and READY beside the remaining symbols. The bird became WATER BREAK after a vote I lost to thirst.

At the next rehearsal, everybody understood the cue. Nobody needed to agree what kind of bird it was.

Aiden's verdict. The cue cards keep their pictures alongside plain words. PAUSE means a real pause, the bird means water, and the old crown-or-jukebox debate remains outside operational instructions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam premise and declared input categories; developer Rundisc replies of December 4, 2023 and March 23, 2024 explicitly confirm stealth timing and distinguish gamepad from mouse/keyboard. No whole-game no-rush claim.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1931770/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/1931770/discussions/0/4040354734349221032/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P148 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Heaven's Vault

Edition considered: PC release

Explore archaeology through an evolving character story, if translations that remain uncertain make discovery more interesting than simply finding a correct answer.

What you do. Talk with characters, examine inscriptions and explore the world while developing and revising theories about its ancient language.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Exploration includes sailing and navigation; camera or held travel input and heavy interpretation memory need checking.

Why it might click. Heaven's Vault follows archaeologist Aliya and her robot companion Six through a network of places and histories. Translating an ancient language is woven into an adaptive story, where discoveries and interpretations affect the journey. It offers grown-up curiosity, character exchanges and the possibility of forming a theory that later evidence complicates.

The full catch. This is more than a static translation screen: exploration includes navigation and sailing, and the source describes fast-flowing space rivers. Check camera movement, sustained travel input and the handling of those sequences. Tracking inscriptions, earlier interpretations and story choices can be demanding. Do not read its reflective subject matter as proof that every physical action waits comfortably.

Try this first. Try one conversation and one inscription before evaluating a travel sequence separately. Keep a translation provisional and notice whether uncertainty feels intriguing or merely burdensome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P148 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Heaven's Vault

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ancient Inscription Said Bring the Jacket

Heaven's Vault made interpreting old language sound like an adventure. Dez produced a folded Blue Comet note, and I declared it a summit relic demanding expert translation.

Nia squinted at the handwriting. "I'm not qualified to complain."

Kit found three possible readings. June insisted the final line said bring the jacket. Dez said it said bring your courage, which sounded more romantic and considerably less likely to return clothing.

Rae examined the back. There was a shopping list.

"Nigga, whoever wrote this also wanted onions."

The grand historical interpretation briefly collapsed. Then June laughed and remembered the supper afterward. Dez remembered the rain. Neither recalled exactly which words had been written, but both remembered waiting beneath the same awning.

Mika put a copy beside the museum display with both readings attributed to their speakers. The original went back into Dez's bag.

I asked which version we should believe. Shawna said I could start by believing that they had both been there.

Aiden's verdict. The display records both readings without selecting a winner. The original note returns to Dez, while the onions provide firmer evidence than my proposed theory of ceremonial courage.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/774201/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

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P149 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Return of the Obra Dinn

Edition considered: PC release

Reconstruct the mystery of a merchant ship that returned without its crew, if a large network of human clues sounds compelling.

What you do. Explore the ship, inspect details and use logical deduction to work out the events connected to its missing crew.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person controls, many identities and disturbing death-related material make this a substantial conditional mystery.

Why it might click. Return of the Obra Dinn casts the player as an insurance investigator examining a merchant ship that has returned without its crew. The developer emphasizes first-person exploration and logical deduction. Its appeal is reconstructing a complicated human mystery through observation, making it a strong story-and-evidence candidate for the right input setup.

The full catch. First-person navigation brings camera coordination and movement holds into the assessment. Connecting many identities and events can also impose a large memory burden, while the ship's fate involves death and disturbing material. The inspected primary description is brief; it does not establish every timing or interaction requirement. Choose it for substantial deduction, not as a low-effort introduction to mysteries.

Try this first. Inspect the opening environment and the investigation interface. Check visual comfort and navigation before deciding whether maintaining a larger network of people and clues sounds enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, pick freely.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P149 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Return of the Obra Dinn

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Nobody Had Died, but the Mirror Was Missing

Return of the Obra Dinn's reconstruction of a ship's human mystery sharpened Rae's interest in our missing dressing mirror. She began asking who had moved what.

I offered a dramatic account involving rival stage interests.

Velvet said she had lent it to Kit. Kit said she had passed it to Remy after finding her glasses. Remy remembered leaning it beside the model hotel while carrying his flowers.

Mika pointed behind my portrait.

There it was, reflecting the back of my expensive head.

"Nigga, the investigator recovered the victim," Tank said.

Rae wrote MIRROR on a plain card and marked its home beside the dressing station. Nobody was accused of a conspiracy, which disappointed me but made the next rehearsal considerably easier.

June asked whether we should do the same with the old jacket. Dez lifted one sleeve and said its current location was visible to anyone with ordinary eyes.

Kit borrowed the mirror again, this time leaving a note.

Aiden's verdict. The mirror returns to a marked dressing station with a simple borrowing note. My conspiracy theory loses every witness, and Dez declines to label clothing she is presently wearing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/653530/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P150 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Opus Magnum

Edition considered: PC release

Build working alchemical machines within a story of ambition, if arranging a mechanism and watching it succeed sounds like the central pleasure.

What you do. Place equipment, sequence its instructions and revise the arrangement until the machine performs the required transformation successfully on its own.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The editor, component placement and sequencing are complex, and optimization comparisons can add unnecessary self-imposed pressure.

Why it might click. Opus Magnum is an open-ended machine-building puzzle about arranging and programming alchemical equipment. Several solutions can work, with optional interest in making them cheaper, smaller or faster. A story of ambition and intrigue surrounds the workshop, while watching a successful mechanism repeat its work provides a distinctive reward.

The full catch. The editor, component placement and instruction sequencing create substantial interface and reasoning demands. Optimization comparisons can introduce self-imposed pressure even when a solution already works. Machine execution speed is not the same thing as required human reaction speed, but exact editing holds and all control requirements still need checking. The narrative is woven around construction rather than replacing it.

Try this first. Follow one introductory construction and make a single operation work. Ignore efficiency comparisons while deciding whether arranging and revising a machine is enjoyable in itself.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P150 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Opus Magnum

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Perfect Machine Delivered One Napkin

Opus Magnum made arranging a working mechanism look deeply satisfying. Remy responded by designing a ceremonial napkin delivery system from a tray, a rotating stand, and Tank.

Tank asked which component received dinner.

I offered to optimize the design. Velvet asked whether optimization would make it less expensive or merely give me another reason to order brass.

Rae watched one cycle. Tank turned the stand, Remy lifted the tray, and a single napkin arrived beside an empty plate. Then the mechanism had to be reset by two people who looked increasingly aware of their evening.

Kit picked up the napkin stack and set it beside the plates.

"Nigga," Tank said, "we been outperformed by putting something down."

Remy laughed and kept the rotating stand for his prop display. I watched it turn a little crown through the light. That was a fine purpose, provided nobody pretended it had solved a catering problem.

Shawna took a napkin without applauding.

Aiden's verdict. The napkins stay within reach, and the rotating stand becomes a prop display. Tank's dinner survives optimization after his mechanical duties are replaced by the ordinary location of a stack.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/558990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The Pen Was Tested on Paper That Did Not Bind Anybody

We reached the rehearsal where everything looked ready enough to tempt me into a premature conclusion. The curtain worked. The light worked. Remy's microphone no longer produced a sound like a distressed kitchen appliance.

I picked up the charter.

Nia put a blank sheet beneath my hand.

"Practice paper."

"Nigga, I know what paper is."

"Then you'll appreciate the distinction."

Rae sat at the table and wrote her name. The pen worked, the table stayed still, and the vase remained far enough away to contribute nothing except looking like a vase. Kit sat next, then Velvet, who signed her stage name with an extravagant sweep that cost no one an extra chair.

Remy drew a small crown. Mika sketched a tiny hotel. Tank wrote DINNER and underlined it twice.

June examined both sides of the blank sheet before writing anything. Dez watched her, then turned the sheet over with a look that made fifty-nine years of Blue Comet argument briefly visible in one wrist movement.

"We can use the same side this time," she said.

June laughed. She did not pick up the actual agreement. Neither did Dez. The moment was a possibility, not a settlement I had permission to announce.

Shawna drew a small heart on the practice page and handed me the pen. I started writing an extravagant dedication. She tapped the little space beside her heart.

"Here."

I wrote our initials, which proved sufficient for the task.

Mika gathered the practice sheets and left the real charter untouched in its tray. Nia still wanted to check the final wording. People still had their own conversations to finish. The room could be ready without requiring everybody inside it to move at the same speed.

I asked whether we could at least have a photograph of the successful rehearsal. Velvet said yes, after she adjusted one earring. Remy waited. Kit moved the lamp. For once, the picture happened when the people were ready instead of when I declared the light historically significant.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P151 / A PLACE TO START

Sokobond

Edition considered: PC release

Make molecular connections into compact logic puzzles, if discovering spatial relationships appeals without needing prior knowledge of chemistry to begin.

What you do. Move through introductory molecular arrangements, observe the result of each action and revise the spatial idea when needed.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed-input support is declared, but key behavior, undo comfort and reasoning demands still need a practical check.

Why it might click. Sokobond turns molecular connections into compact logic puzzles with a minimalist presentation. The developer explicitly says chemistry knowledge is not required. Its current Steam declarations include keyboard-only play and play without timed input, making this a useful candidate when deliberate problem-solving is welcome but reaction pressure is not.

The full catch. A small control vocabulary can still support difficult spatial reasoning. Confirm comfortable key presses, any repeat behavior and how undo works on the actual device. The developer's no-timed-input declaration is useful evidence, not a hands-on comfort guarantee. This is mainly abstract puzzle pleasure; it will not supply the character-rich narrative that motivates some other choices in the catalog.

Try this first. Try one introductory molecular puzzle and learn the result of a single movement. Continue only if revising a spatial idea feels satisfying, without requiring prior chemistry expertise.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P151 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Sokobond

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Chemistry Was Not Required for This Seating Plan

Sokobond's connected pieces made me describe the seating arrangement as molecular diplomacy. Nia looked at Rae, then at the empty chair beside her, and said the chemistry seemed straightforward.

Rae pulled the chair out.

I offered to explain the larger structure. Nobody required it.

Kit wanted a seat with a clear view of the entrance. Velvet wanted to be near the dressing passage.

Remy needed room to set down his microphone case without making it somebody else's footrest.

Mika joined those practical requirements into a layout that looked less symmetrical than my first draft and behaved much better.

June and Dez chose neighboring chairs while denying that this choice resolved any historical dispute. Tank sat beside Rosa and immediately reached for the bread.

"Nigga, what bond is that?" I asked.

"Dependable."

Shawna tapped the chair beside hers. I joined the arrangement without changing anyone else's position, demonstrating an advanced understanding of a system I had nearly ruined by explaining it.

Aiden's verdict. The seating plan connects actual preferences without demanding a lecture. June and Dez retain their disagreement in adjacent chairs, and my advanced contribution consists of sitting where Shawna points.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam source supports chemistry-themed puzzles without required chemistry knowledge. Current developer declarations include Keyboard Only Option and Playable without Timed Input. Those declarations are not a hands-on test of sustained keys or individual comfort. Remote Play Together is not treated as native co-op.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/290260/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P152 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Hexcells

Edition considered: PC original game

Try an ambient cell-based logic puzzle, if studying a compact board and finding a justified next move sounds enjoyable to you.

What you do. Read the board's instructions, inspect its cells and make selections based on the relationships you can establish from the clues.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The primary description is brief; exact input, readability, holding and full timing requirements remain unresolved.

Why it might click. Hexcells is presented by its developer as an ambient logic puzzle. Its compact cell-based format offers a different kind of interest from walking through a world: inspect the board, understand its rules and look for a reasoned next step. It is a candidate for someone who likes deliberate abstract deduction.

The full catch. The inspected primary description is unusually brief, so it does not substantiate a full no-timer or hold-free claim. Check the game's instructions, cell readability and the distinction between its input actions before relying on it. A sparse screen does not guarantee an easy deduction. This original Hexcells entry should not inherit features or extra modes from the separate Plus and Infinite games.

Try this first. Read the opening board instructions and make one move whose reason is clear. Check whether selecting and distinguishing cells feels comfortable before increasing the puzzle size.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P152 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Hexcells

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Six Sides Did Not Make a Better Place Card

Hexcells' compact logic board inspired Kit to cut hexagonal place cards. I admired the shape so much I suggested using every edge for a different ceremonial title.

Rae held up one blank card. "Could we try a name?"

"Nigga, that's only one side."

"It's the useful side."

We wrote names clearly and left the other edges alone. Nia's attempt at her own card looked like a small mountain range. Rae wrote a second version while Nia made an unnecessarily careful show of choosing its position beside hers.

Velvet requested larger lettering for stage visibility. Remy wanted KING RECEIPTS on one side and REMY on the other, so he could turn the card when the performance ended.

That was a use I hadn't imagined. Kit made it neatly.

My card read AIDEN in ordinary letters. Shawna drew a tiny star beneath it when nobody else was looking. I stopped asking for the other five titles.

Aiden's verdict. The place cards favor readable names over spare-edge ambition. Remy receives two clearly distinguished sides, and Shawna's private star satisfies a host previously demanding five additional titles.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

The exact-game Steam page describes an ambient logic puzzle; its short primary text does not establish full controls or timing. The separate sequels' features were not imported. Detailed input verification remains outstanding.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/265890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P153 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Tametsi

Edition considered: PC release

Work through demanding tile logic with drawing tools and saved progress, if making a supported deduction is itself a satisfying reward.

What you do. Inspect tile relationships, reason about hidden mines and use the drawing tools to keep notes while developing a solution.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The developer explicitly calls it difficult; large clue relationships, tile visibility and exact controls still need checking.

Why it might click. Tametsi offers demanding logic puzzles about finding hidden mines among tiles. The developer says solutions do not require guessing, provides on-screen drawing tools for notes, and saves progress even within a level. For someone who enjoys careful deduction, those features can support a substantial problem without requiring an immediate answer.

The full catch. The developer also explicitly describes the game as difficult. Large patterns, written notes and relationships between clues can become mentally busy even when the physical action is modest. Verify the click controls, tile visibility and stopping behavior on the device. The inspected text supports automatic progress saving, but it does not explicitly certify every input as hold-free or every activity as untimed.

Try this first. Try an early board and write down one deduction with the available note tools. Decide whether the reasoning itself is enjoyable before treating more difficult boards as an objective.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P153 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tametsi

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Glitter Was Somewhere We Hadn't Counted

Tametsi's careful deduction put Kit in a methodical mood just as Mika discovered loose glitter near the signing table. We needed to know which decorations were shedding before the papers arrived. I suggested guessing.

Kit looked at me over her recovered glasses.

"That was a test," I said.

Rae inspected the garland. Remy checked his crown. Velvet shook her boa gently over a clean tray and proved, with some satisfaction, that the expensive feathers were innocent.

The trail led to my ceremonial sash. Every time I insisted on walking through the middle of the room, another little constellation appeared.

Mika replaced it with a plain ribbon. June brushed one last spark off Dez's sleeve and said the Blue Comet had never needed this much cleanup. Dez reminded her about the broken jukebox bulb.

Kit wrote the remaining checks on a card. We finished them one by one, and the table finally stopped looking as if it had hosted a tiny explosion.

Aiden's verdict. The shedding sash leaves the ceremony and a plain ribbon takes its place. Kit's remaining checks proceed by inspection, while June's claims of historical tidiness encounter a broken bulb.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/709920/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P154 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Mario Paint

Edition considered: 1992 SNES original; SNES Mouse input

Make a playful picture in the original SNES creative toy, using stamps and fills as a narrow first activity to enjoy.

What you do. Choose a stamp and a fill color, place a few elements and experiment with a small picture using the mouse.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Original hardware needs the SNES Mouse; other tools involve dragging, many icons add clutter, and Gnat Attack requires reactions.

Why it might click. The original SNES Mario Paint is a creative toy for pictures, music and animation, built around the SNES Mouse. Stamping and filling areas offer a narrower first activity than exploring the entire toolbox. Its appeal is making something playful, with nostalgia as an optional bonus rather than a requirement.

The full catch. The original hardware needs the mouse peripheral. Manual instructions distinguish simple selections from held-button dragging used by other tools, so the whole program is not hold-free. Many icons and palette choices can create menu clutter. The separate Gnat Attack activity adds reaction demands and is outside this suggested stamp-and-fill trial. This is creation, not a character-story adventure.

Try this first. Choose one stamp and one fill color, then make a small picture. Leave freehand dragging, animation and the reaction minigame aside while checking mouse comfort.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P154 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mario Paint

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Mario Could Paint the Banner Faster Than My Committee

Mario Paint's little creative tools persuaded Remy to design a simple welcome image instead of ordering another enormous photograph of me.

He made a microphone, a chair, and a bright uneven heart. Kit suggested clearer letters. Velvet requested enough sparkle in the drawing that we could stop shedding it in the room.

I asked where the host appeared.

Remy added a small crown on an empty chair.

"Nigga, that's a vacancy notice."

Shawna liked it. She said a welcome picture should leave room for people to arrive. Mika printed a draft at a sensible size, and Rae held it beside the entrance.

June and Dez argued over the heart's color, then both agreed the chair looked comfortable. Tank asked whether the microphone might also be a breadstick. Remy refused to settle the question.

The banner went up. For the first time all afternoon, somebody entering the room smiled before discovering how much I had spent.

Aiden's verdict. The welcome image uses a chair, a heart, and a disputed microphone-shaped breadstick. My portrait stays off the banner, which performs its welcome without requiring anyone to admire the host.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo announcement confirms the 1992 original; original Nintendo manual transcription, hosted by a third party, distinguishes stamps/fills from held dragging and the separate Gnat Attack activity. Card scope is original SNES Mouse play, not an automatic claim about modern ports.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/whatsnew/mario-paint-scribbles-into-the-super-nes-collection/>

Source 2: <https://manualzz.com/doc/26101036/nintendo-mario-paint-family-user-manual>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P155 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Color a Dinosaur

Edition considered: 1993 NES original

Revisit an unusual NES coloring toy if choosing colors for simple pictures is exactly the small retro activity you want.

What you do. Select a picture, choose colors and fill a few regions, trying the manual's narrow point-to-point coloring arrangement first.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Its child-oriented style and limited variety may rule it out; full timing and modern-device behavior remain untested.

Why it might click. Color a Dinosaur is an original NES coloring toy with a deliberately small activity loop. Its manual describes selecting pictures and filling regions with colors, including a point-to-point control arrangement. It belongs here as a specific retro curiosity for someone who wants that simple action, not as a substitute for adult narrative.

The full catch. The presentation is aimed at young children and the variety is limited. That may be a taste veto regardless of how few controls are needed. The original manual supports the coloring controls, while full-play timing and modern-device behavior have not been tested here. Mode changes can affect the drawing; check the intended setup rather than assuming an emulator reproduces every behavior conveniently.

Try this first. If the retro coloring idea itself appeals, fill a few regions in one picture. Stop the trial once its narrow appeal is clear; completing a picture is optional.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P155 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Color a Dinosaur

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dinosaur Got the First Uncontested Color

Color a Dinosaur was a deliberately tiny activity, which made it perfect for settling our absurd argument over the rehearsal cards. Everyone wanted a different border color.

I announced a palette summit.

Rae said we were already at one and wanted dinner.

Dez chose green for the dinosaur picture on the screen. June said it suited him. The ease of this agreement stunned me so thoroughly that I tried to declare the old war over.

"Baby, we agreed on a dinosaur," June said.

Velvet laughed, then picked a border for her own cue card. Kit chose another. Mika added the same plain words to both, so the colors could differ without changing the meaning.

"Nigga," Tank said, "the animal got us farther than your speech."

I chose gold, naturally. Shawna let me, because my card was now small enough that the decision affected almost nobody else. Even decorative ambition improved when contained inside a reasonable rectangle.

Aiden's verdict. The cue cards may use different colors while keeping identical plain instructions. June declines to confuse agreement about a dinosaur with a treaty, and dinner remains a live demand.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Original manual scan, hosted by a third party, was visually examined in the earlier project research (work/retro-games.json); current reopen yielded no searchable text. Manual-supported point-to-point coloring is a narrow option, not a tested whole-game or emulator guarantee. Wrong Steam coloring-game match excluded.

Source 1: <https://www.digitpress.com/library/manuals/nes/Color%20a%20Dinosaur.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P156 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Incredible Machine 3

Edition considered: 1995 Windows original

Revisit a historical contraption puzzle if making an unlikely chain of cause and effect succeed is the attraction you remember.

What you do. On an existing working setup, inspect an introductory contraption and change one component to observe the resulting chain of effects.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Primary mechanics verification, exact controls, current availability and compatibility remain unresolved; setup could overwhelm the intended evening.

Why it might click. The Incredible Machine 3 is a historical contraption-building puzzle candidate: arrange parts into chains of cause and effect to achieve an objective. Its appeal is seeing an unlikely mechanism succeed after a useful adjustment. This 1995 Windows entry is included for a revisit if an existing copy and workable setup are available.

The full catch. Evidence is weaker here than for the modern store entries. A Sierra historical archive identifies the game, but its descriptive text credits a secondary database; the linked scanned manual was located without usable text verification. Exact mouse actions, timers, compatibility and present availability remain unresolved. Do not mistake this historical candidate for a certified easy-to-run or hold-free recommendation.

Try this first. On a working existing setup, inspect one introductory contraption and its controls before changing a single component. Avoid turning software setup into the evening's main activity.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P156 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Incredible Machine 3

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Incredible Machine Was a Person Opening the Curtain

The Incredible Machine 3's chain reactions encouraged me to sketch a ceremony opener involving a rolling ball, a tipping flag, and a bell that would release the curtain.

Rae stared at the page. "Who resets it?"

"An attendant."

"Then the attendant could open the curtain."

Remy liked the sketch anyway. He built a harmless tabletop demonstration with a marble and a little flag while the actual stage retained its ordinary pull. Kit watched the flag fall and applauded the tiny success.

Darnell arrived with a much more complicated proposal, a cocaine-party anecdote, and a yacht reference before reaching the second sentence. Mercedes pointed him toward the snack table.

"Nigga, take the long version somewhere with sandwiches."

Mika kept Remy's miniature machine in the display. It could amuse people without controlling the whole evening. Shawna asked me to pull the actual curtain once. I did. It opened beautifully, requiring neither a theory nor a marble to announce her entrance.

Aiden's verdict. The chain reaction becomes an optional tabletop amusement, while a person handles the curtain. Darnell's extended proposal travels toward sandwiches without gaining a role in the stage machinery.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Explicit source gap: historical Sierra archive page inspected, but its descriptive prose credits MobyGames. Original scanned manual located, not successfully read for mechanics in this pass. Primary identity locator is available; detailed controls, timing, current availability and compatibility remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://www.sierragamers.com/tim-3/>

Source 2: https://www.sierragamers.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/12/TIM_3_Manual.pdf

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P157 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

SimCity 2000 Special Edition

Edition considered: PC Special Edition

Build and manage a classic city if planning how its parts support one another sounds as interesting as watching the skyline grow.

What you do. Inspect a city, use its building and service tools and respond to the relationships between the settlement's needs.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Budgets, services, simulation behavior and old menus add substantial complexity; pause behavior and no-pressure modes were not verified.

Why it might click. SimCity 2000 Special Edition offers the classic city-building and management fantasy, with the ability to design a settlement and respond to its needs. The current exact-edition store description includes additional cities and scenarios. It may appeal through nostalgia, long-term planning and the satisfaction of a place taking shape.

The full catch. Management brings budgets, services, tools and simulation behavior into the same interface. This is a meaningful increase in menu and system complexity, not a default low-demand choice. Check speed controls, pausing, the ability to inspect while paused and the readability of the old interface on the intended setup. The reviewed sources do not establish a special no-pressure mode or hold-free operation.

Try this first. Inspect an existing city or an introductory situation and identify one service before building extensively. Decide whether managing relationships between systems sounds enjoyable, rather than merely liking the skyline.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P157 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

SimCity 2000 Special Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My City Had a Monument and No Toilets

SimCity 2000 made planning a whole place look irresistible. I expanded our model ceremony into a miniature capital with a central monument, two plazas, and a boulevard named after Shawna.

She asked where the toilets were.

I explained that the capital was ceremonial.

"Nigga, so are a lot of emergencies."

Mika added the practical rooms and routes already agreed in the annex. Rae placed the food where it could be reached. Velvet put the dressing area near the stage instead of behind my monument.

The beautiful boulevard shrank. The place began working.

June examined the model and said her old bus route would never have cleared my original corner.

Dez reminded her she had once clipped a flowerpot. June said the flowerpot had been badly governed.

Tank moved my monument to the small display table. I kept Shawna's name on the boulevard, now a very short route between our chairs and the courtyard. She approved its improved destination.

Aiden's verdict. The miniature capital acquires practical rooms and loses an obstructive monument. Shawna's boulevard survives at a useful scale, while June's disputed flowerpot incident remains outside the transport assessment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Special Edition GOG listing and official EA title page inspected. Supports city design/management and edition identity; pause behavior, no-pressure modes and present-device control comfort were not verified.

Source 1: https://www.gog.com/en/game/simcity_2000_special_edition

Source 2: <https://www.ea.com/games/simcity/simcity-2000>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P158 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

Edition considered: PC Deluxe edition

Design a familiar little amusement park if caring about its visitors and finances is part of the attraction alongside building rides.

What you do. Place or inspect attractions, arrange the park and manage the guest needs and finances surrounding its operation over time.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Menus, money and scenario demands can create pressure; prebuilt rides do not remove the wider management system.

Why it might click. RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe combines the original park-management game with its two expansion packs. It offers both custom coaster construction and prebuilt rides, alongside the business of keeping guests and finances in order. The pleasure can be a recognizable little park evolving through practical and creative decisions.

The full catch. Designing rides is only part of the game: management menus, guest needs, money and scenario demands can create pressure. Check simulation speed and pause behavior, exact mouse operations and interface size. The presence of prebuilt rides does not remove the rest of the management system, and this edition should not be credited with modes from later RollerCoaster Tycoon releases.

Try this first. Inspect an opening park or scenario and locate one prebuilt attraction in the interface. Evaluate whether the management surrounding construction feels interesting before committing to a large custom coaster.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P158 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ride Was Two Chairs and My Big Mouth

RollerCoaster Tycoon's park-building fantasy gave me a final dangerous thought: what if guests entered the signing ceremony on a little moving platform?

Mika's eyes lit up. Rae closed hers.

Velvet asked whether the platform could manage her costume. Kit asked whether it could simply remain still. Remy wanted to know if its fanfare came included.

The quotation arrived before we agreed to anything. That cured Mika.

"Nigga," Tank said, "we could pay everyone to walk."

June and Dez took two chairs at the front and began narrating the imaginary ride. June supplied the uphill anticipation. Dez supplied the terrible drop into my bank account. The entire room joined the scream.

I bowed as if I had commissioned the entertainment on purpose.

Shawna pulled me into the chair beside her. The actual floor did not move. Somebody brought drinks. I had to admit this attraction had remarkably good capacity, excellent comfort, and no additional installation fee.

Aiden's verdict. The moving entrance is abandoned before purchase. June and Dez provide a seated parody instead, and the ordinary floor earns favorable reviews for remaining exactly where guests expect it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/285310/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P159 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Theme Hospital

Edition considered: 1997 PC original

Run a satirical institution if exaggerated operational problems and resource management sound entertaining, rather than looking for a personal character adventure.

What you do. Design and maintain the hospital, manage its staff and rooms and balance the resources needed to keep it operating.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Busy menus and simulation pressure need checking, while fictional illnesses and death may make the subject unwelcome.

Why it might click. Bullfrog's original Theme Hospital is a comic management game about designing and running an institution with limited resources. The official EA page emphasizes building, maintaining and managing the hospital while balancing cash and its exaggerated fictional problems. Its appeal is institutional satire and operational tinkering, rather than a rich personal adventure.

The full catch. Staff, rooms, resources and developing demands can make this a busy management choice. Its comic visual style does not remove time pressure or menu work. Check pausing, speed behavior, readable text and the exact mouse controls before assuming a relaxed setup is possible. The humor includes exaggerated illnesses and death, which may simply be the wrong subject for an enjoyable evening.

Try this first. Inspect the early building and management interface without committing to an elaborate plan. Decide whether its subject and overlapping responsibilities are appealing before taking on the continuing simulation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P159 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Theme Hospital

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hospital Admitted My Budget

Theme Hospital's comic institution made Velvet declare an emergency consultation for our wounded ceremony budget. She seated me opposite her and asked where the spending hurt.

"Mostly in areas people haven't appreciated yet."

"Chronic," she said.

Rae brought the hardware receipts. Mika brought the revised layout. Kit carried one lamp that did the work of the three I had first ordered. Remy arrived as King Receipts with a clipboard and an appalling bedside pun.

"Nigga, don't operate on me with that joke."

We removed duplicate rentals, kept the technician's actual work, and paid Velvet's agreed fee without trying to cure it. The budget looked less feverish.

June said the Blue Comet had once balanced an entire evening with a coffee tin. Dez said June had forgotten who bought supper afterward.

Velvet handed back my pen. "Stable enough to stop ordering."

Shawna took the catalog from my other hand before I could challenge the discharge conditions.

Aiden's verdict. The budget retains useful work and the agreed performance fee while shedding duplicate rentals. I am released from consultation on the strict practical condition that Shawna keeps the catalog.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Official EA page identifies Bullfrog's original 1997 Theme Hospital and building/management with limited resources. The automatic Steam hit was unrelated DLC and is excluded. Exact pause/hold behavior remains to be checked.

Source 1: <https://www.ea.com/games/theme/theme-hospital>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P160 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Zoombinis

Edition considered: 2015 PC remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis

Guide familiar blue travelers through a cartoon logic journey if its particular nostalgia and pattern-discovery charm are what you want tonight.

What you do. Try the remake's puzzle types, notice patterns and make choices that help the travelers continue toward their new home.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The child-oriented style is a real taste limit; difficulty, dragging, penalties and timing require puzzle-specific checks.

Why it might click. This is the 2015 remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis, a cartoon adventure built around pattern and logic puzzles. The developer describes twelve puzzle types with several difficulty levels as the travellers seek a new home. It may appeal through nostalgic character, rule discovery and a sequence of distinct reasoning tasks.

The full catch. The child-oriented presentation is a real taste consideration, especially when the desired experience is a grown-up character story. Logic difficulty can increase independently of that appearance. Check the specific puzzle's clicking, dragging, penalties and timing; the store description does not establish a universally untimed or hold-free route. This entry refers to the remake, not every older edition or platform version.

Try this first. Try one early puzzle and explain the pattern you think matters. Check whether helping these characters feels charming before investing in harder levels or the larger journey.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P160 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Zoombinis

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Travelers Reached a Table That Finally Worked

Zoombinis sent its travelers toward a new home through different reasoning problems. Our own procession faced the last rehearsal route: entrance, clear passage, chair, table, and a pen that actually wrote.

Mika invited people to try it in whatever order suited the check. Nobody had to perform the signing itself.

Kit reached her light. Velvet cleared the arch. Remy found his microphone. June and Dez sat together, still debating whether the Blue Comet jacket had been borrowed or strategically relocated.

Nia stopped beside Rae and asked if they could talk after the rehearsal. Rae smiled.

I lifted the charter, ready for a grand premature conclusion.

Shawna lowered my hand.

"Nigga, the room's ready. The words aren't."

We set the unsigned paper in its tray. The stage held everything it needed without requiring anyone to disappear into a role. Tank brought the last snacks over, and for once I announced nothing before taking one.

Aiden's verdict. The ceremony is ready for people, while the charter stays unsigned for the remaining conversations. The last rehearsal ends with snacks instead of an unauthorized declaration that everybody has agreed.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/397430/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The Stage Could Hold the Peace, If We Ever Finished Talking

At the final equipment check, the table stood still. I pressed one corner to confirm this personally, then another because I disliked being excluded from a successful test.

Rae watched me. "You can stop trying to make it interesting."

The curtain opened. Velvet stepped through, made her turn, and reached the microphone with her costume intact. Remy followed at the agreed distance, delivered one deliberately terrible fanfare, and bowed before the joke became an endurance event. Kit found the light flattering enough to defend publicly.

Mika checked the route from the quiet room. June took it at her own pace. Dez walked beside her with the Blue Comet invoice safely inside her bag. They could reach the table without climbing, squeezing past my portrait, or listening to an explanatory recording about why the route was grand.

Mercedes played a few notes. Porsche listened from the seat she had chosen. Tank set down the snack tray where it could be reached, and Rosa immediately proved the placement successful.

"Nigga," I said, "look what we built."

Shawna looked at the room. Then she looked at me.

"Yes. We did."

The word we landed properly that time. It included the hotel workers, the people who measured, the people who asked for a chair, the people who cut a bad idea, and the people whose costume needed more room than my first sketch allowed. It also included me, though not always in the position I had drawn for myself.

I picked up the lever one last time. Remy asked whether I wanted it in the museum or the return box.

"The return box."

Tank put a hand to his chest as if witnessing a miracle. I threatened to order something just to restore his understanding of the world. He handed me a plate before I could act.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The new charter remained unsigned. Its final wording belonged to the next conversations, including matters too personal for my microphone. Nia crossed the room to Rae with no page in her hand. Rae set down the toolkit. Whatever she asked next was quiet enough that neither I nor the ceremony needed to own it.

June and Dez sat beside the finished stage. One remembered the first Blue Comet song; the other remembered the last. Mercedes asked them to hum both. The versions disagreed, but she found a few notes that let them begin together.

I almost announced the second war over. Shawna kissed the beginning of the announcement away.

"Not yet."

"Then what now?"

She took my hand and led me toward the seats. "Let them talk. Sit with me."

The stage was ready. The paper could wait. I sat down before somebody found another useful thing for me to carry, and discovered that this, too, counted as contributing to the peace.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

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Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.